or responsibilities. Roles enable more consistent assignment and management of access, even as systems and teams expand.

In the next section, we'll explore RBAC in detail, including how it helps organizations simplify access management while preserving alignment with business logic.

5.2 Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

After struggling to manage a tangle of ACLs and hardcoded exceptions, ACME Corp's identity team decided it was time for a more structured approach to authorization. Their first step was to define a handful of roles that accurately reflected the company's operational structure. Roles such as `customer-support`, `support-lead`, `engineer`, and `senior-engineer` became the building blocks of access across the organization.

Instead of assigning permissions directly to users or adding names to lists on each resource, ACME began assigning permissions to roles and roles to people. Now, when a new support rep joins the team, granting access to tools and data is as simple as assigning the `customer-support` role. If someone changes jobs, their access changes when their role changes—there's no need to hunt down every ACL they are listed on.

Figure 5.2 shows how ACME Corp uses RBAC to assign users to roles, assign roles to permissions, and define role hierarchies that reflect organizational structure.